Associated Organisations:

London Sharad Utsav
London Sharad Utsav (LSU) is a recently formed Bengali Social Organisation engaged in cultural, social and sports activities.
For further information: please visit www.londonsu.org, contact Anirban 07717 005344

Sri Aurobindo Society (UK)
A Registered Charity. The address is 149 Eastcote Lane, South Harrow, HA2. It is open to the public. On Saturdays and Sundays it is open for meditation from 6.00pm to 7.00pm.
Contact Telephone: 020 8422 9920

International Society for Krishna Consciousness (ISKCON)
Bhaktivedanta Manor, the Hare Krishna Temple (Watford) at Dharam Marg, Hilfield Lane, Aldenham, Herts, WD25 8DT. It is a Registered Charity. It is accessed by car from A41.
Website: www.krishnatemple.com, contact telephone 01923 851000

Ramkrishna Vedenta Centra
It is a Registered Charity. It is situated in a little village called Bourn End at Blind Lane, Buckinghamshire, SL8 5LG. The centre can be accessed from M40, either Exit 3 or Exit 4.
Tel: 016285 26464

Aid India Forum
Reg Charity No. 262210
Helping social and educational projects in India**.** Contact telephone 020 8907 5946

Gaudiya Misson (UK)
A registered charity celebrating Sri Chaitanya Mahaprabhu. Address:
27 Cranhurst Road, London NW2 4LJ (near Willesden Green Tube)
Contact : www.gaudiyamission.com, tel 020 8452 2733

Panchamukhee Group
A registered charity based in Harrow, engaged in cultural and social activities.
Contact: www.panchamukhee.org, contact Sourav 07894 465953

Dr Sudin Mandal	Mrs Aparna Mukherjee	Cllr Mrinal Choudhury
President 020 8864 8717	Secretary 020 8422 2663	Treasurer 020 8907 5946

ICICI Bank www.icicibank.co.uk Tel: 08081 31 41 51 (free Phone)
Local Branch: 29 College Road
Harrow, HA1 1BA T: 020 8515 2286

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কালীবাড়ি খবর

KALIBARI NEWS

(Registered Charity 286688)
Visit us at: www.londonkalibari.org.uk

Kalibari Centre: 18 Byron Road, Wealdstone, Harrow, HA3 7ST
(Kalipuja Issue), Issue 4, November 2013

From the President

Dear Kalibari Members and Friends
Welcome to the Kalipuja Issue of our Newsletter.

We have been organising Kalipuja and Diwali since our inception in the early 80's. Starting at the Hindu Centre at Chalk Farm, we moved to Denis Jackson Hall at Wembley, then on to the Ealing Town Hall, and in recent years the event is being held at the Harrow Arts Centre. In the earlier years we used to combine the Puja with a short music and dance event, but this proved impractical due to insufficient time available. So now we concentrate on the Puja during the evening and holding the music event on another day.

A few members have asked us as to how we finance the evening's celebration. Usually the donations and collections on the evening roughly match the expenditure. When there is a surplus, it goes to the Kalibari Building Fund. On rare occasions when there was a deficit, additional contributions were made by the members of the Management Committee to bring the two in balance. As an illustration of the total expenditure, for the 2013 celebration it is expected to be around £2,400 excluding donations in kind by individual members.

We have seen a higher level of participation from the community since we started using the Kalibari Centre in early 2012. We are holding our first community Art Exhibition in the week before Kalipuja. I hope you will continue to support us in building a permanent Kalibari Community Centre.

Bank of Baroda (London Kalibari Banker)
London main Office 020 7457 1515
www.bankofbarodauk.com
Local Office –213 Kenton Road, Harrow, HA3 OAA
Telephones – 020 8909 1739, 020 8907 1358

Secretary's Report: (Highlights)

During the past year we have held 11 Management Committee meetings at the Kalibari Centre. We are holding regular dance (Saturday) and music (Friday) classes in the Centre and we are looking for more students to take up this opportunity. The current students have also taken part in our cultural functions.

We have organised a talk and cultural function on the occasion of 150th birthday of Swami Vibekananda. On alternate Mondays we have had talks and discussions on the Bhagbat Gita from the visiting monks from the Bhakti Vedanta Manor at Watford (ISKCON).As this newsletter goes to print, we are organising an Arts Exhibition of local artists and we are hoping it will be a great success (more about this in the next Newsletter).

Please give your support and donations (preferably through monthly giving) to help us meet the running costs and build up our Building fund.

Treasurer's Statement:

a) Long term savings - £115,000 b) Cash flow £8,000
c) Regular Income & Expenditure: (approx. per month)

Income –	Standing Order	£260	
	Luncheon Club	£ 70	
	Hall Hire	£ 80	
	Donation	£ 70	
	Utsav	£ 50	
		£530	
Expenditure -	Rent	£500	
	Council Tax	£15	(Small Business Rate Relief)
	Water	£ 20	
	Gas & Electric	£ 60	
		£595	

In the year ending 31 March 2013 we have made a net income of £16,911 as a result of all our activities and the money has been moved to the Building Fund. Please support us generously to make the dream of the community a reality.

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কালীবাড়ি খবর

London Kalibari Cummunity Centre Project

London Kalibari (**Reg charity 286688)** www.londonkalibari.org.uk is an organisation representing the Hindu Bengalee Community in the UK. It is a democratic organisation with a constitution and is a charity registered in 1982. It has raised funds for the Community Centre Project through many social and cultural activities.

Since February 2012 we have acquired a (small) rented accommodation at 18 Byron Road, Harrow and we have been using this place as our Interim Kalibari Centre to hold our regular activities.

The objective of the Kalibari Community Centre project is to acquire or develop a (larger) permanent Community Centre to provide the facilities for the following:

- Social, spiritual and religious functions
- Family counselling services
- Music, dance, drama, art, literature and language classes
- Yoga, meditation and self-improvement classes
- Meeting facilities particularly for retired people and very young families
- Library facilities

The rented place we are currently using is too small to accommodate the numbers we are facing for the popular activities and there are no on-site parking facilities. A larger and more suitable property is estimated to cost around £1 Million. Efforts are being made to obtain external funding (e.g. from the lottery fund), but a significant proportion of the money will have to be raised from the community. London Kalibari has a Building Fund of just over £110,000 and pledges of some £50,000 have been received from Kalibari members.

The premises will be available to other local groups for their social, cultural, artistic and educational uses. The centre will facilitate and encourage cultural and spiritual exchanges between the Hindu Bengalee Community, the larger Indian community and other local communities and thus provide cultural and spiritual enrichment for the wider society.

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Story and Myth of Ma Kali (continued from last page)

Her white teeth show purity while the red tongue signifies her shame when she sets foot on her husband Shiva. Kali's four arms represent the circle of creation and destruction. Her right hands indicating fearlessness and conferring boons, the left hands with a bloodied sword and a severed head, meaning her destruction of false ego with the sword of knowledge. Kali's three eyes represent the sun, moon and fire, to observe the three modes of time: past, present and future.

Many Forms- Kali is worshipped by many names - Black Goddess, Maha Kali, Nirtya Kali, Smashana Kali, Raksha Kali, Shyama Kali, Kalikamata, Kalaratri- depending on what one wishes to achieve. For example, if someone wants to get rid of fear, one would use the form called Shyama Kali. If there were disease or some other disaster afoot, the form would be Raksha Kali.

Bengali Tradition and Mantra- In Bengal, Kāli is venerated in the festival of Kali Puja – during the new moon day of Ashwin month which coincides with the Diwali festival. Two famous temples in Kolkata are dedicated to Ma Kali called Dakshineswar and Kalighat. A significant portion of Bengali devotional music features Kāli as its central theme and is known as Shyama Sangeet.

The mantra for Kali worship is called Devi Argala Stotram. (in English script):

(Sarvamaṅgalamāṅgalyē śivē sarvārthasādhikē . śaraṇyē tryambakē gauri nārāyaṇi namō'stu tē Oṃ jayantī mangala kālī bhadrakālī kapālinī . durgā kṣamā śivā dhātrī svāhā svadhā namō'stutē.)

Sujit Bhattacharjee

Salon Sleek, www.salonsleek.co.uk and www.sleekacademy.com
Hair and Beauty
3 & 17 Kenton Park Parade, Kenton Road, Harrow, HA3 8DQ
Tel: 020 8909 9633, & 020 89099393

কালীবাড়ি খবর

Cultural Secretary's report

Please see the following for our forthcoming events.

Kalibari Regular Acitivities at London Kalibari Centre

1. Monday Yoga Class 11.30 AM, Luncheon Club 12.30 PM, Talk on Spiritual / Historical subjects 1.00 PM
2. Wednesday Advice Surgery (proposed) 10.30 AM to 12.30 PM
3. Last Friday of the Month with Workshop (proposed) 6.30 PM
4. Full Moon and New Moon Utsav (Celebration) every month
5. Friday yoga Class 10.00 AM to 11.00 AM
6. Saturday Dance Class 12.30 PM
7. Music Class 6.00 PM (alternate Fridays)
8. Kalibari and Other Community Organisations Meetings

Calendar Year 2013
August - 25th - Satyanarayan Pujo (Full Moon) – Sunday 3.00 PM
October : Art Exibition
27 Sunday (3.00 PM to 5.00 PM) and Monday 28th (6.30 PM to 8.30 PM)
November - 2nd - Kali Pujo 6.30 PM to 10.30 PM
At Hatch End Suite, Harrow Art Centre (Ph: 020 8416 8989)
November- 9th, 10th or 11th (Date to be decided)- Bijoya Utsav.
December- 21st - Christmas Party

Calendar Year 2014
January- 18th – Mahapurush/Mahamati Dibosh
February- Kali Pujo (New Moon) Date not fixed
March -Free – item to be announced
April - 14th - Naboborsho / Bangali Dibosh.
Suggested VENUES - Flash Musical or, Harrow Civic Centre
May – Satyanarayan Pujo (Full Moon) - Date to be fixed.
June - Kalibari Annual Cultural Event – Date to be fixed
Suggested VENUES Zoroastrian Centre, Bhavan or, Rudolf Steiner Hall.

Taste of Asia: 3 Mason Avenue, Wealdstone, HA3 5AH, tel 020 8424 2151
Sri Lankan and Indian Cuisine, Specialists in catering for weddings and parties (also take away delivery) www.thetasteofasia.co.uk

London Kalibari wishes to thank the following:

1. London Kalibari Life Members.
2. Members from the Community.
3. Harrow Council for Grants and Accommodation.
4. Harrow Council for Small Business Rate support
5. Harrow Art Centre
6. Recent large contributors (above £500 and giving by Standing Order))
7. Cllr Navin Shah, Wealdstone Labour Hall for arranging the rental of the Kalibari Centre.
8. a) Mr Tony McNulty Ex-MP of Harrow East, Labour Party and
   b) Mr Gareth Thomas, MP of Harrow West, Labour Party for their support.
9. Councillors of Harrow Council for their support and encouragement.
10. Sponsors of Kalibari events & activities.
11. Ms Tanuka Saha, of N. Saha & Co. Chartered Accounts
12. Sri Robin Ray, Kalibari Priest
13. Our local artists, Arijit Chakravarty and Rishi Banerjee
14. Kakali Misra and Sajali Roy
15. Prof. Bhaskar Dasgupta and Dalia Dasgupta
16. London Sharad Utsav, Chhandam and Panchamukhee

Please note: Our intention is that when we have acquired a permanent centre, all contributions will be acknowledged, and those contributing significant amounts will be specially named (such as on a board or on a plaque).

Donations: Please make cheques payable to London Kalibari. For Standing Order, amount to be sent to Bank of Baroda, Kenton Branch, 213 Kenton Road, Harrow HA3 0AA, Account No: 91001547, Sort Code: 60-95-57

Management Committee Members:

Dr Sudin Mandal, Mr Ajit Ghosh, Mrs Aparna Mukherjee, Cllr Mrinal Choudhury, Mrs Krishna Ghosh, Mrs Rama Choudhury, Mrs Jayati Das, Mr Kanu Roy, Mrs Debjani Sengupta, Mr Anirban Mukhopadhayay, Mr Sandip Choudhury, Mrs Aparna Gupta, Mrs Sikha Choudhury and Mrs Babli Majumder

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Story and Myth of Ma Kali

This issue of the "Kalibari News" is special because it is the forerunner to worshipping Goddess Kali in November. It is therefore an opportune moment to remind ourselves of the story and myth of Ma Kali, particularly as Kali is very often depicted to our younger generation as a fearsome Goddess only.

Meaning-The name Kali comes from *kāla*, which means "she who is black" - the first creation in the universe before light itself. It also means "she who is time and death" i.e. one who has the potential to both destroy and create. She is the consort of Lord Shiva and empowerment of his strength (Shakti). The fierce aspect of the goddess Durga (Parvati), she is also revered as Bhavatārini, the redeemer of the universe and as a benevolent Mother Goddess.

Kali's Birth- There are several stories about Kali coming into existence. According to one legend, Kali came out of the seven tongues of fire emanating from the God of Fire. Another legend says Kali emerged from the brow of Goddess Durga in her battle with Mahishasura. Once born, the black goddess went wild until Shiva stopped her destructive rampage, by lying down in her path. In another version, Parvati transformed herself into Kali by emerging from Shiva's throat to kill the mighty demon Daruka - who could only be killed by a woman. Finally, there is the story of the terrible demon Raktabija, who was causing havoc, because of his ability to produce more demons every time a drop of his blood spilt to the ground. Durga created Kali who then killed Raktabija by chopping off his head and drinking all of his blood to make sure none of it fell to the ground.

General image-Though Kali's fierce appearance fills one with awe, the real meaning of her form is not what it appears - it has deeper significance. For instance, Kali's nudity means that she is free from all illusions (maya). Kali is full-breasted, to imply that her motherhood is a continuous creation. Fifty human heads in her garland represent the fifty Sanskrit letters of knowledge and wisdom.

(continued on next page)

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